

Part of Global Summit 2026 - RV College of Engineering

HORIZON 2040 — *Build Beyond Today*

Concept Paper · Pan-India Problem-Solving Hackathon, Open to All Indian Students · Format: Hybrid · Team Size: 2–5 ·
Expected Finalists: 80–100 Teams

Domain: Open / technology-agnostic — software, hardware, AI, robotics, communications or design, chosen by teams to fit the problem

HORIZON 2040 moves away from fixed technology categories and organizes the hackathon around real-world problem spaces instead. Teams are given a significant problem — not a prescribed technology — and asked, "How would you solve it?" The aim is problem-first innovation: a national platform where students from engineering, design and data science backgrounds build solutions that matter for a world shaped by 2040.

Platforms: Online hackathon-hosting services (e.g. Agorize, hack2skill, HackerEarth, HackCulture), alongside a dedicated event website

Two-Stage Structure

Stage 1 — Online Preliminary Round

Open to teams across India, registering via the selected platform. Submission: problem definition, target users, existing gap, proposed solution, tech approach, innovation and expected impact (prototype/demo optional). Standardized evaluation shortlists 80–100 teams, qualifying track-wise into the Grand Finale.

Stage 2 — Offline Grand Finale (Bengaluru)

Shortlisted teams build working prototypes on-site with development environment, technical mentorship, industry interaction and partner tech access. Judged primarily on what is built and demonstrated; teams may pivot based on feedback.

Prizes: 1st Prize – ₹3,00,000 | 2nd Prize – ₹2,00,000 | 3rd Prize – ₹1,00,000

Duration: 1-day final round (24-hour buildathon)

Funnel: National Outreach → Online Registration → Idea Submission → Online Evaluation → 80–100 Finalist Teams → Bengaluru Grand Finale (24-hour buildathon).